

Housing Recovery & Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) Gorkha District Meeting Minute

Date: February 24, 2016

Time: 9:00 AM

Venue: HRRP office, Hotel Gurkha Inn

Facilitated By: Minar Thapa Magar

HRRP IM Officer: Swopnil Maskey

Attendees:

CRS, JICA, IOM, OXFAM, CARE, NEDS, SAHAS NEPAL, ECO Nepal, WVIN, SDSC,
Save the Children , Goreto, Practical Action, NCRS, WHR, CRS/ HRRP

Agenda:

1. Introduction
2. HRRP Update
3. Partner's commitment and VDC allocations for subsidy enrollment assistance
 - i. Social Mobilization
 - ii. Technical Assistance
 - iii. Proposal for good enrollment sites
4. Update on Partners Mason training and importance of contextualization of Mason Training
 - i. JICA's build back better housing training by Amit Timilsina, JICA (TIPS-ERP)
 - ii. Model construction during trainings, CRS
5. Partner's commitment on working sessions
 - i. Construction Monitoring Checklist
 - ii. Pre-posttest for 10 key messages
 - iii. Design of house as per Northern Aspects
 - iv. Assistance in enrollment process
6. AOB

Summary of the meeting:

HRRP district focal point Minar Thapa Magar facilitated the meeting focusing on importance of assistance for subsidy enrollment and how organization can contribute to reconstruction program other than providing subsidy. He also discussed the role of HRRP for successful subsidy enrolment and benefits for organization while working with HRRP. Partner organization gave updates about their activities and shared innovative ideas for future assignments.

Introduction

HRRP is a coordinating platform which acts as an interface between partner organization and government bodies. Its main objective is to facilitate the reconstruction and recovery process by facilitating the

communication bridge between organizations itself and with government. HRRP focuses on removal of duplication and smooth functioning of reconstruction process. For the cause, HRRP is responsible for dissemination of information from Central government to district base organization and vice versa.

Updates

- NRA has announced that any organization who wants to contribute for reconstruction cannot implement directly for building houses but can assist for subsidy enrolment process. They can contribute in:
 - Social Mobilization
 - Technical Assistance
 - Proposal for good enrollment sites
- If any organization is willing to provide subsidy, they can give it through government channel (i.e. NRA)
- Data from Gorkha HRRP were presented in central level and was highly appreciated.
- HRRP and NRA announced that subsidy will not be provided in VDC's where mason training is not provided and each VDC must trained sufficient masons certified by DUDBC.
- NRA has decided that every red card holder will not receive subsidy and a CBS (Central Bureau of Statistics)'s survey has been carrying out in different VDCs for identification of beneficiaries for subsidy enrollment.
- HRRP announced the availability of HRRP hall for partner organizations. In case of need, organization must inform a day in advance

Agency Updates

- OXFAM has already enrolled their social mobilizers in their working (five) VDCs and will establish an information center in each working VDC. They have limited manpower for full level of assistance but they have agreed to assist for subsidy enrollment process.
- Nepal Development Society mentioned their willingness to develop a resource center to train people for long term reconstruction. They are planning to establish the resource center in Chitwan and take people from Gorkha to train there for long term.
- Save the Children updated HRRP about their work progress and plan. They are working in 8 VDCs along with masons training for reconstruction. They informed HRRP about their social mobilizers in those VDCs who will assist for soft loan. They have a target to support 300HH for reconstruction including training for 200 masons and carpenters and build 8 model houses.
- Save the Children presented a Mason training selection criteria and form and willing to share it with HRRP to get inputs from other partners and uniformity of those forms is very essential so that there will be similar criteria for 2 partners working in same VDC.
- Practical Action has completed training of 240hrs for plumbers and electricians.
- CRS informed that they are planning to work in 14 VDC's and also committed to assist NRA during enrollment process.
- JICA has allocated 24 VDCs as their work areas. They have divided VDCs into two clusters namely Barpak Cluster with 9VDCs and Bungkot Cluster with 15 VDCs. They are planning to initiate mason training soon in those VDCs.
- SAHAS Nepal informed to support 55 HHs in Thumi VDC but after getting information about NRA policy they will discuss about their plan.

- NCRS informed HRRP that they have their shelter program running in 3 VDC's. ODK is also being carried out and they informed that they have assigned one volunteer and one social mobilizer in each of their working VDCs. They informed that PASA training is completed in Harmi, ThalaJung and Shreenathkot.
- IOM informed HRRP that they had launched their program for 10 key messages using social mobilizers. As of date, they have already disseminated the message for 420HH.
- Rubinala Youth Nepal Showed their willingness to assist for subsidy enrollment process. They also notified about the event they are organizing on April 24 where more than 100 volunteers are participating. They requested to use this opportunity for awareness purpose as well.

Key Discussions

- HRRP representative Minar Thapa Magar discussed about the role of social mobilization and training for long term influence regarding sustainable reconstruction.
- Save the Children raised a discussion about procedure for contributing in subsidy enrolment. Minar gave the basic guidelines for the procedure but since the actual procedure is yet to be announced, he assured the information would be circulated as soon as it is disseminated by the NRA.
- Practical action raised a discussion about the involvement of women in trainings. In their past experience, it was very difficult to enroll women in mason training.
- Discussion about selection of mason for training was carried out among partners. Regarding the issue, save the children demonstrated the form they had prepared for selection process which was appreciated by HRRP. Similarly, partners suggested including Ward citizenship forum and VDC secretary for the selection purpose to make selection process more effective. HRRP suggested partners to develop and use a common form to maintain the uniformity in selection process.
- Adeel from CRS discussed about the removal of duplication while working in VDC's. He also requested HRRP to advocate with government about the selection of sites for enrollment. He suggested to map the enrolment sites which would be logistically accessible.
- HRRP requested partners to give site suggestions as they have been working in most of the VDCs and possess a better idea for selection of appropriate site for enrollment.
- CARE discussed about the importance of dissemination of information regarding provision of subsidy as soon as possible to the people as they still think possessing a red card makes them eligible for subsidy. It might create problem in near future during the enrolment process.
- Partner IOM discussed about lack of Mason Training in Ghairung VDC and requested other partner organization to enroll mason training in Ghairung as soon as possible before the enrollment of subsidy.
- HRRP strongly appeals partners for timely updates (Every two weeks) of mason trainings as NRA shall conduct Mason training program only in those VDC's where no training has been conducted in order to save resources and avoid duplication.
- Partners discussed about enrolment of masons from each ward for effective reconstruction process.
- Partner organization JICA presented a presentation on JICA's build back better housing training updates and procedures. Following are some of the key points from JICA's presentation
 - JICA is focusing more on practical trainings rather than theory.
 - Binding with bamboo, bricks and cement models are used.
 - Female participation was seen very less in Sindhupalchowk practices.

- JICA has been providing guideline booklet for construction of houses.
 - Training of House owners.
 - Innovative use of mascot for spreading key messages.
 - Mobile orientation has been carried out for awareness.
 - Design and Concept of Resource Center.
 - Demo Model House within the periphery of resource center
 - Awareness thorough different innovative ideas like theatrical performance.
- Similarly, partner organization CRS also presented their presentation of their mason training updates and procedures and importance of demonstration constructions as practical sessions of Mason Training. It included the following basic information:
 - Trainings for Skilled and unskilled manpower.
 - Demo House and Demo model constructions.
 - BBS awareness/programs
 - Mobile team/ Engineering Help desk.

Action Points:

- Adeel from CRS suggested developing a construction checklist for proper monitoring and evaluation of reconstruction process.
- For Construction Monitoring Checklist and pre-posttest of 10 key messages, the willing organizations are CRS, IOM, CARE, OXFAM and Save the Children.
- For Design of the houses as per Northern Aspects, Assistance in enrollment process the interested organizations are OXFAM, CRS, IOM, CARE and Practical Action/Goreto.
- IOM suggested for the inclusion and involvement of government for the construction monitoring checklist.
- HRRP Gorkha will be coordinating among partners to get commitment in assistance for enrollment process to help Government.
- HRRP Gorkha will start mapping enrollment sites and requested partners to propose enrollment sites as they may have clear picture of their working VDCs.
- HRRP requested partners to provide update on their activities(especially Mason trainings) and updates should be done by partners in every 2 weeks.

Contact list

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